# The Memory Cycle Journal

LEAD STORY · KEY NUMBERS · FROM THE INBOX · ON X · CYCLE TRACKER · EVENTS


**KOREA WEDNESDAY — CLOSE**
**KOSPI 5,375.36** +2.60%; Samsung ₩206,000 +3.57% · SK hynix ₩1,277,000 +5.36% · KRX via Naver

**KOREA EXPORTS NOV 1–10 · DRAM SPOT WEDNESDAY**
**Chips +331%** $16.6bn, 49.7% of exports; DDR5 16Gb $60.233 (+0.11%); DDR4 16Gb $79.867 (−0.15%) · KCS, TrendForce

**LEAD STORY**

KOREA · EXPORTS · SPOT

## Korea's Chip Exports Quadruple in Early November as Seoul Extends Its Rebound

Semiconductor exports for Nov. 1–10 rose 331% from a year earlier to $16.6 billion, half of everything Korea shipped. SK hynix gained 5.36% on Wednesday even after a weak US session in which Nvidia fell 5.47%. DDR5 spot edged up after two flat sessions.

**By the Memory Cycle Desk** · Tel Aviv · ~08:35 IST Wednesday (UTC+2) · Korea = final close · US = Tuesday close · Spot TrendForce Nov 11 11:00 GMT+8 · CONFIRMED unless marked

**KEY NUMBERS · KOREA WEDNESDAY CLOSE · US TUESDAY CLOSE · SPOT WEDNESDAY**

**KOREA, WEDNESDAY CLOSE**

| | |
|---|---|
| KOSPI | **5,375.36 (+2.60%)** |
| Samsung | **₩206,000 (+3.57%)** |
| SK hynix | **₩1,277,000 (+5.36%)** |
| Exports Nov 1–10 | **$33.5bn (+111.9%)** |
| Chip exports Nov 1–10 | **$16.6bn (+331.2%)** |

**US TUESDAY CLOSES AND SPOT**

| | |
|---|---|
| Micron | **$725.11 (−1.10%)** |
| Sandisk | **$859.99 (−2.99%)** |
| SOX | **9,998.33 (−0.35%)** |
| Nvidia | **$168.89 (−5.47%)** |
| DDR5 16Gb spot | **$60.23 (+0.11%)** |
| DDR4 16Gb spot | **$79.87 (−0.15%)** |

What this shows: Seoul ignored Wall Street's soft session. The SK hynix ADR fell 3.51% to $129.66 on Tuesday, then the Korean shares rose 5.36% on Wednesday on the export data. DDR5 spot ticked up and DDR4 kept easing. NAND wafer spot ($16.15, −4.33% w/w) is carried from the last weekly print. US Oct CPI rose 0.4% (core 0.3%), above forecasts; the 10-year yield rose to 4.98%. Sources: KRX via Naver Finance, Korea Customs Service via Yonhap Infomax and Maeil Business, Yahoo Finance, CNBC, BLS, TrendForce.

Korea's exports for the first ten days of November reached $33.5 billion, up 111.9% from a year earlier and a record for the period. Daily average exports rose 97.7% to $4.46 billion. Semiconductors brought in $16.6 billion, up 331.2%, and made up 49.7% of exports, 25.3 points more than a year ago. Computer peripherals, which include SSDs, rose 237.7%. Imports rose 45.0% to $24.7 billion, leaving a surplus of $8.8 billion. Chip export values reflect prices as well as volumes.

The KOSPI closed at 5,375.36 (+2.60%), its second straight gain after November's sell-off; Samsung closed at ₩206,000 and SK hynix at ₩1,277,000. Preliminary exchange data on Naver show foreigners net bought about ₩655.3bn, a second day of buying; Hankyung put their November net selling at ₩10.57 trillion before the turn. In New York on Tuesday the SOX slipped 0.35% to 9,998.33. Micron fell 1.10% to $725.11 after touching $699.63, and Sandisk 2.99% to $859.99. Broadcom rose 3.91% and AMD 1.30%. Spot DRAM was mixed: DDR5 16Gb rose 0.11% to $60.233 and DDR5 eTT 0.33% to $30.40, while DDR4 16Gb slipped 0.15% to $79.867 and 8Gb 0.24% to $44.893. TrendForce's Tuesday spot report said branded-chip trading was quiet and RDIMM module prices were correcting downward.

**Our call:** late upcycle; tight through 2027 / into 2028. Unchanged overall. Near-term evidence is a touch firmer (record chip exports, a DDR5 spot uptick, CoreWeave's demand comments). The 2028 debate is a touch looser (Morgan Stanley's terminal-margin cut and new warnings about CXMT capacity).

**CYCLE SIGNAL: DEMAND DATA FIRM; 2028 DEBATE OPENS**

BROKERS · SUPPLY 2028

## Morgan Stanley Cuts SK Hynix Target 38% as the Debate Moves to 2028

Morgan Stanley cut its SK hynix target price 38% to ₩1.6 million and Samsung's 19% to ₩309,000, while raising its 2027 operating-profit forecasts by 13% and 9%, the Korea Herald reported. It lowered SK hynix's average operating margin for 2029–35 to 28% from 53%. It moved about 4.9 GW of data-center capacity from 2028 into 2029 and expects new memory supply from late 2027, a setup it calls a 2028 earnings-cliff risk. It stays Overweight on both, with Samsung preferred. Nomura holds targets of ₩4.7 million and ₩670,000 and sees demand above supply at least through 2028. SK hynix has said long-term agreements with 14 customers cover more than half of its 2027–28 capacity. Separately, Charles Kau, a former Nanya president, told Taiwanese media that TSMC would never make DRAM. He warned that CXMT is building 10 fabs and could bring large capacity online within two years, risking a glut. He doubts its $4F^2$ DDR5 parts will reach mass production soon (TrendForce, Nov 11).

AI DEMAND · NVIDIA

## CoreWeave Raises Its Backlog as Nvidia Slides on Its CEO Probe

CoreWeave reported third-quarter revenue of $3.66 billion, against a $3.55 billion LSEG estimate. It guided 2026 revenue to $13.0–13.3 billion and lifted its backlog to about $132.5 billion; the shares rose about 7% after hours (CNBC). Nvidia fell 5.47% to $168.89 and briefly traded below a $4 trillion market value as its board's probe into Jensen Huang continued; a shareholder class action has been filed (CNBC). A Taiwanese paper, Commercial Times, reported supply-chain talk that Nvidia may slow chip orders, with AMD and ASIC designers such as Alchip, GUC and MediaTek possibly taking freed capacity. UNCONFIRMED Nvidia reports on Nov. 17. MediaTek's October revenue was NT$55.03 billion, up 5.77% from a year earlier and down 0.67% from September.

**FROM THE INBOX** · SINCE TUE ~08:00 IST · READ-ONLY

NEW **More HBM per chip.** Google's TPU 8i Max reportedly carries 384 GB of HBM, up from 288 GB, with bandwidth doubling to 17.2 TB/s. Jefferies pre-market, citing TrendForce and Newsis (Nov 10)

NEW **Data-center permits: the risk is 2028.** TrendForce raised Texas and Georgia to severe regulatory risk, Wisconsin to high and Oregon to severe after a statewide permit pause. Most 2027 capacity is already under construction, so delays mainly hit 2028 and later. TrendForce Data Center Tracker (Nov 11)

NEW **Taiwan's AI supply chain accelerates.** Eight sub-sectors grew more than 10 points faster in October, including server assembly (+81% y/y), CCL/PCB (+98%), design services (+216%) and CoWoS equipment (+75%); the PC chain stayed weak. Andrew Lu newsletter (Nov 10)

DEMAND **AWS stays capacity-short.** AWS chief Matt Garman said AWS will be capacity-constrained for a couple of years and could sell out every accelerator arriving in 2027 today. Podcast hosts expect PC units down 20%+ next quarter, with memory prices driving demand elasticity. TMTB podcast digest (Nov 10)

## ON X · SINCE TUE ~08:00 · IST

**@pequityresearch** · Nov 11 06:12
Relays BofA: a memory super-cycle through 2028, with market revenue of $0.97T in 2026, $1.47T in 2027 and $1.58T in 2028, and a 2028 "soft landing" with DRAM +10%.
x.com/…/2120368922151325763

**@jukan05** · Nov 10 08:26
Korean media: Samsung aims to finish developing its hybrid-bonded 3D Cube-H stack by early next year.
x.com/…/2120040448781889711

**@aleabitoreddit** · Nov 11 07:42
CoreWeave's call: "10x as much qualified demand as available capacity," plus price increases.
x.com/…/2120391635737649423

**@intelfabs** · Nov 10 10:00
Morgan Stanley's memory key debate: "AI didn't kill the memory cycle. It made the boom bigger," with a 2028 earnings-cliff risk.
x.com/…/2120063923332534704

**@HyperTechInvest** · Nov 10 14:45
"$NVDA slows down chip orders" as the smuggling allegations come under DOJ investigation.
UNCONFIRMED
x.com/…/2120135734858535162

## CYCLE TRACKER · NEAR-TERM A TOUCH FIRMER; 2028 DEBATE A TOUCH LOOSER

| GAUGE | TODAY VS NOV 10 (KPI WATCH LIST) | NUDGE |
|---|---|---|
| **Contract ROC** | No new public contract print (October posted Oct 30). Korea chip exports Nov 1–10 +331% y/y in value. MediaTek Oct −0.67% m/m | **Rising** |
| **Spot vs contract** | DDR5 16Gb $60.23 (+0.11%, after two flat days); DDR4 16Gb $79.87 (−0.15%), 8Gb $44.89 (−0.24%). RDIMM correcting. NAND wafer $16.15 carry | **Steadier** |
| **Lead times / demand** | DRAM lead time 18 weeks (no new weekly). CoreWeave backlog ~$132.5bn; AWS capacity-short for years; TPU HBM 288→384 GB | **Long; demand firm** |
| **Supply growth / capex** | MS: new supply from late 2027, 2028 cliff risk. Kau: CXMT building 10 fabs. TrendForce: permit delays hit 2028+ | **Tight 2027; 2028 looser** |
| **Valuation** | MS cuts targets but raises 2027 profit; SOX forward P/E down 51% while forward EPS rose 24% (MS). Nomura and BofA see tightness through 2028 | **Debate, not derating** |

**VERDICT VS PREVIOUS CALL (NO. 35, NOV 10)**
Late upcycle; tight through 2027 and into 2028. Unchanged overall. Near-term evidence is a touch firmer: chip exports quadrupled, DDR5 spot ticked up, and CoreWeave and AWS describe demand well above capacity. The 2028 view is a touch looser: Morgan Stanley sees new supply from late 2027 and cut long-run margins, and an industry veteran flags CXMT's 10-fab build. Brokers still disagree on 2028; the playbook's late-cycle signs (falling contract prices, longer inventories) have not appeared.

## EVENTS CALENDAR · NOV 11–24 · ISRAEL TIME (IST, UTC+2) · US CASH OPEN 16:30

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Wed Nov 11** | Veterans Day: US equities open, bond market closed | Macro |
| **Thu Nov 12** | Nebius before the open · Hon Hai results · Applied Materials (call 23:30), Cisco and SMIC after the close · Advantest IR fireside chat (results were out Oct 28) | WFE |
| **Fri Nov 13** | US PPI (October) 15:30 | Macro |
| **Tue Nov 17** | Nvidia FQ3 (call 00:00 Nov 18) · SC26 Nov 17–19 | HBM |
| **Wed Nov 18** | House chairs' requested closed-door Huang briefing · Kulicke & Soffa (est.) and Soitec after the close | Policy |

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| **Thu Nov 19–20** | Sandisk 8-for-1 split effective after Nov 19 close; split-adjusted Nov 20 · Anthropic IPO pricing expected | NAND |
| **Mon Nov 23–24** | HPE results (est.) · Jefferies EM conference, Dubai · Watch: Korea Nov 1–20 exports, TrendForce NAND weekly and month-end contract prices | Prices |

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Unconfirmed reports are labeled as such. Figures are only those cited from named sources. · Edition #36 · Nov 11, 2026